



Figure 1: IRC Cloud



Figure 2: Bugzilla

an IRC client developed by Mozilla. If not that, you can use different clients such as *Mibbit* or *IRCCloud*, based on what suits you.

After opening the chat client, to connect to the Mozilla server, just type the following in the IRC client:

```
/server irc.mozilla.org
```

Once you have connected to the Mozilla server, you can join the *Introduction* channel, which is for beginners. To join it, use the following command in the IRC Client:

```
/join #introduction
```

This is where you can start asking any general questions or those related to bugs. Depending on the bug that you have taken on and the availability of your mentor, you can directly communicate with him or her. There are a lot of people in Mozilla who are ready to help you at any point of time.

Selecting a bug from Bugzilla

Once you are ready with the build, you can go to *Bugzilla* to search for bugs. As a beginner, it is recommended that you start with minor or trivial bugs. Once you find a bug, just mention it in the 'bug comments' section—that you are interested in working on this particular one. After some

time, you will get that bug assigned to you.

Once you are done with selecting a bug, you can ask for any help regarding the bug in *#introduction* on the IRC. While fixing a bug in Mozilla, you have to find out a particular function that you need to modify. In this case, you can use *mxr* or *dxr*. With these two sites, you can search for a file, a particular word or a module.

After you have fixed the bug, you have to make a patch, for which you have to use Mercurial.

Using Mercurial to create a patch

A patch gives you the changes you made to the code. The mentor of the bug fixing process then reviews the changes in the patch and tests them. For this you need to add the following lines to the *hgrc* file that you have created previously—to give a path to the Mozilla central repository:

```
[ui]
username = Name <example@xyz.com>
```

```
[defaults]
qnew = -Ue
```

```
[extensions]
```

```
mq =
```

```
[diff]
```

```
git = 1
```

```
showfunc = 1
```

```
unified = 8
```

This helps you to create a perfect patch for the bug that you have fixed. After you attach the patch to the bug, you can wait for the mentor to review it. 

References

- [1] <http://www.mozilla.org/en-US/>
- [2] https://developer.mozilla.org/en-US/docs/Developer_Guide/Source_Code/Mercurial/Bundles
- [3] <http://chatzilla.hacksrus.com/intro>
- [4] <http://mibbit.com/>
- [5] <https://www.irccloud.com/>
- [6] <http://mxr.mozilla.org/>
- [7] <http://dxr.mozilla.org/mozilla-central/source/>

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